



LIMITED SOURCE JUSTIFICATION (LSJ) FOR BRIDGE TASK ORDER TO SUPPORT COMPETITIVE EFFORT

Solicitation 47QFRA25K0004

MV-22 Tiltrotor Aircraft Maintenance

in support of:

Marine Medium Tiltrotor Training Squadron 204 (VMMT-204)
United States Marine Corps (USMC)
New River, Marine Corps Air Station (MCAS)

**United States (U.S.) General Services Administration (GSA)
Federal Acquisition Service (FAS)
Assisted Acquisition Services (AAS) Army/Air Force/Navy/Space Force**



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The General Services Administration (GSA) Assisted Acquisition Services (AAS) makes this Limited Sources Justification (LSJ) for orders pursuant to Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) 8.405-6.

1) Identification of Agency and Task ordering Activity:

Agency:

GSA AAS acting in support of Marine Medium Tiltrotor Training Squadron 204 (VMMT-204), United States Marine Corps (USMC) New River, Marine Corps Air Station (MCAS)

Task ordering Activity:

GSA AAS Contracting Office (QFSA)

2) Nature and/or Description of Action Being Approved:

GSA, FAS, AAS requests approval to award a bridge task order for Maintenance Support (CMS) for Aircraft Maintenance for the MV-22 Osprey. The USMC's previously competitively awarded Task Order (TO)(47QFRA24F0003) was under an automatic stay in response to a Government Accountability Office (GAO) protest which was received on November 13, 2023. Because of the urgent nature of aircraft maintenance services and the unexpected stay, GSA was unable to responsibly award a competitive action at that time, and instead, awarded a bridge (47QFRA24F0004). Following the issuance of a GAO decision, GSA took corrective actions in Feb 2024. However, after revised proposals were received as part of this corrective action, the contracting officer determined that concerns could not be mitigated with the current approach and award could not be made without significant changes. On June 13, 2024, the Government elected to address the concerns by restarting the process with a revised PWS and solicitation. The bridge was then extended for an additional 12 months with an amended limited source justification, resulting in coverage through May 23, 2025. As the Government completes the competitive task order action, an additional bridge task order is required to prevent a lapse in service.

The bridge task order will be a limited source TO awarded to GSA Multiple Award Schedule (MAS) task order AVMAC LLC., a Service-Disabled Veteran-Owned Small Business (SDVOSB). It will be a Firm-Fixed Price (FFP) TO with Not-to-Exceed (NTE) CLINs for Travel and Overtime, for a nine (9) month base period and FAR 52.217-8 Option to Extend Services to be utilized in case of another protest.

3) A Complete Description of Supplies/Services Required to Meet Agency's Need (Including the Estimated Value):

The estimated price for the nine (9) month base and FAR 52.217-8 periods is \$ [REDACTED]

VMMT-204 is the Department of Defense's (DoDs) largest source of MV-22 Osprey pilot and crew training. It is responsible for the training of USMC, United States Air Force (USAF) and United States Navy (USN) pilots and crew chiefs. Once training is completed at VMMT-204, these trained personnel report to active duty and reserve USMC, USAF, and USN squadrons for operational tasking.

The USMC VMMT-204 squadron is the only military unit providing support aircraft readiness for the training of DoD and Foreign Military Sales (FMS) pilots on the V-22 Osprey tiltrotor aircraft. The V-22 is the basic aircraft model. Service specific variances account for the different nomenclature, such as MV-22 (Marine Corps) and CMV-22B (Navy). The only way to provide the necessary level of readiness for the training program is through CMS services. Specifically, the CMS provides maintenance for 22-24 MV-22 aircraft, which are used by not only the USMC, but also all other Services, for pilot training.

The 22-24 MV-22 aircraft being maintained account for approximately three MV-22 squadrons requiring significant maintenance man-hours, with Saturday and Sunday being the only days without 24 hours of on-going maintenance. Government maintainers cover some of the manpower for a 12-hour daily shift during the week, all other shifts are covered exclusively by CMS. Aircraft maintenance support for the MV-22 Osprey at MCAS New River, NC, requires highly skilled and certified maintainers to ensure aircraft availability for pilot training hours. This TO sustains a single point of failure for all V-22 aircraft pilot training for the United States Marine Corps, the United States Air Force, the United States Navy, and Japanese Defense Force personnel. The scope of supported entities spans across the globe and facilitates pilot replenishment to support real world operations across the DoD and to establish pilot training and maintenance efforts for Japanese FMS aircraft. Short term delays in pilot production will have multi-year effects on the pilot population sustainment if CMS production is stopped, even for a brief period.

The USMC itself does not have enough trained airframe mechanics, flight-line mechanics, electrical/avionics mechanics, system support specialists, supply technicians, and logs and records technicians to support O-Level scheduled and unscheduled maintenance on these aircraft. The Government needs this CMS support to perform troubleshooting, inspections, corrosion prevention/treatment, servicing, lubricating, adjusting, and the removal and replacement of aeronautical components. Since the Government does not have enough personnel of its own, the Government needs CMS personnel to augment USMC maintenance personnel at the squadron in order to keep maintenance activities going at satisfactory performance levels.

The period of performance for the bridge TO will consist of a nine (9) month base and FAR 52.217-8 Option to Extend Services. This performance term is the minimal amount of time needed in order to minimize any lapse in service and allow for the completion of the competitive task order action that will be worked simultaneously with the bridge task order. Based on projected milestones for full recompet, transition

period of 30 to 60 days and INFORM process, the IPT has determined that 9 months is sufficient time to cover a competitive award process.

4) The Authority and supporting rationale:

The limited source justification is using the authority of FAR 8.405-6(a)(1)(A), as an urgent and compelling need exists, and following the procedures would result in unacceptable delays.

While this TO is specifically for the USMC, the impact of a lapse in service is much broader than just the USMC. As stated above, these MV-22 aircraft are used for all DoD pilot training required to operate the V-22. The MV-22 is a joint service, multi-mission aircraft with vertical take-off and landing (VTOL) capability. It performs VTOL missions as effectively as a conventional helicopter while also having the long-range cruise abilities of a twin turboprop aircraft. The versatility of the MV-22 makes it equipped for a number of critical mission areas for the military, specifically as an assault transport for troops, equipment and supplies being deployed from ships, or for expeditionary airfields ashore. Specific impacts are as follows:

The USMC forward deploys MV-22 squadrons to support preplanned and contingency operations, sometimes at a moment's notice. The USMC MV-22 community supports multiple units that provide worldwide operational support within the United States European Command (USEUCOM), United States Central Command (USCENTCOM), United States Indo-Pacific Command (USINDOPACOM), and United States Africa Command (USAFRICOM) areas of responsibility. Delays to MV-22 pilot and aircrew training would reduce operational squadron manning and combat readiness, which would significantly impact DoD operational support.

The USAF CV-22 community provides critical support to the United States Special Operations Command (USSOCOM) assignments across the globe. A much smaller community than the USMC, USAF CV-22 pilot training delays would be felt immediately and would negatively impact US Special Operations assault support deployments. USAF pilots trained at VMMT-204 (with support from CMS) this fiscal year are needed to deploy in support of these assignments within the next 12 months.

The USN pilot training mission at VMMT-204 will continue until September 2025. The USN provides combat search and rescue, delivery and retrieval of special warfare teams, and crucial fleet logistic support transport. Delays to pilot and aircrew training supported under CMS would negatively impact these operational requirements and would, without question, delay squadron stand-up and subsequent deployments in support of the USN carrier strike group operations.

The full requirement to meet operational need is 116 USMC pilots (replacement aircrew, refresher aircrew, and transitional pilots), 12 USAF pilots, and 14 USN pilots with an additional 90 maturation hours. VMMT-204 (with support from CMS) is further tasked with training 102 USMC and USN crew chiefs. VMMT-204 flight operations also maintain the currency of five (5) Bell Japanese Defense Force Task

Order Instructor pilots and five (5) Bell Japanese Defense Force Task order Instructor crew chiefs this fiscal year. These high levels of output require the full complement of the VMMT-204 maintenance department, to include uniformed and CMS personnel. VMMT-204 maintains an assignment of 22-24 aircraft and heavily relies on CMS to support the squadron's USMC, USAF, and USN missions. CMS support enables VMMT-204 to maintain 24-hour maintenance support five (5) days a week, the loss of this capability would reduce maintenance touch time by 33%. VMMT-204 also relies on CMS to train incoming military maintainers as the task orders retain a significant portion of the squadron's maintenance experience and qualifications. Doing so also enables VMMT-204 to support deploying squadrons with uniformed maintenance personnel. The loss of CMS support would not only diminish VMMT-204 maintenance capacity, but it would also impact the supply of deployable personnel to operational USMC squadrons.

Additionally, continued delays to meeting CMS Full Time Equivalent (FTE) requirements would have secondary and negative effects. It has historically proven difficult to quickly recover from a deficit of 10+ task order employees, usually taking a month for the hiring and training of new personnel. New personnel will require a minimum of three (3) weeks simply for training in accordance with the requirements of Commander, Naval Aviation Instruction (COMNAVAIRINST) 4790.2D; Naval Aviation Maintenance Program (NAMP) (4790.2D).

This hiring process is often complicated by general company workforce attrition. By stopping work and affecting individual FTEs, the CMS VMMT-204 estimates a loss of approximately 25% of the current workforce. This severe personnel shortage would place both the task order and the squadron severely behind schedule. It is estimated to take upwards of 6-9 months for stabilization and to return the workforce to full strength. Depending on the length of the delay to CMS task order support, the resulting reduced maintenance capability could eventually cripple the DoD's V-22 community and negatively impact the operational readiness of the USMC, USAF, and USN. Estimated minimal impacts are:

- A. • VMMT-204's current and reduced maintenance capability would immediately experience diminished weekly flight training events by 50%.
- B. • After two (2) weeks without CMS, FY25 pilot production would be reduced by three (3).
- C. • After four (4) weeks without CMS, FY25 pilot production would be reduced by nine (9), nearly 40% of an individual squadron's requirement.
- D. • After 12 weeks without a CMS, FY24 pilot production would be reduced by 27, more than 100% of an individual squadron's requirement.

The training VMMT-204 (with CMS support) provides to V-22 pilots and aircrew directly relates to supporting conventional and special operations troops in training and on operations across the globe. After only two (2) weeks of lost support, impacts would be felt to the provision of pilots and aircrew for deploying squadrons. After 12 weeks of lost support, nearly 25% of the FY25 pilot production mission would be impacted. Based upon throughput capabilities, it is anticipated to take upwards of two (2) years to

recover from pilot training losses. The effect on national security will be acute if CMS support is delayed.

Due to the impacts discussed above, the need to ensure continued operational coverage is paramount while the Government completes the competitive task order action; and due to this pressing need, following procedures which would require onboarding and training of new personnel would undoubtedly result in unacceptable delays which would reverberate throughout the military for an extended period of time.

5) Determination by the Ordering Activity Task ordering Officer that the Order Represents the Best Value Consistent with FAR 8.404(d):

A competitive best value award determination was previously made for this requirement with competitive pricing and past performance before it was protested and terminated. Best value was determined in accordance with the solicitation, per the RFQ, "award will be made on a best value basis, as defined in FAR 2.1. Definitions, "Past performance is more important than price," and "The Government may award to other than the lowest priced offer or other than the highest rated." AVMAC, who is currently performing the task order was determined to be the best value to the Government. The rates quoted do not exceed the rates on schedule that have also been determined to be fair and reasonable during the competitive award process. The Independent Government Cost Estimate (IGCE) also used the Wage Determination for the local area 2015-4389, Rev 29 dated December 23, 2024, and based on those rates the Government can determine the rates provided by the incumbent to represent fair and reasonable pricing. Based on the above facts, the order is determined to be the best value to the Government.

6) Description of the Market Research Conducted Among Schedule Holders and the Results of the Research:

This bridge TO will maintain continuity of operations until the conclusion of a competitive recompet. Past market research indicated only two capable sources held the specific experience necessary for this requirement. This was further confirmed after the Request for Quotation (RFQ) for the competitive action was released on August 25, 2023, via GSA eBuy on MAS 488190 as a small business set-aside and two quotes were received for task order 47QFRA24F0003. That TO was awarded to AVMAC on November 1, 2023, with performance starting on November 2, 2023. Recent market research on March 17, 2025, revealed that a limited number of sources are on GSA Schedule 488190 that are able to perform this requirement, and of those only two have expressed interest on recent Requests for Information. Given the limited number of capable sources and the extreme urgency to resume aircraft maintenance services, no source other than AVMAC LLC is capable of immediately meeting the Government's requirement for performance. This bridge TO is being put in place only for the shortest amount of time necessary in order for the Government to responsibly competitively award a new task order.

7) Any Other Facts Supporting the Justification:

The contractor (AVMAC) currently performing the task order is determined to be the only responsible source that can maintain organizational maintenance responsibilities within the required timeframe, preventing further lapse in service. AVMAC has the expertise, installation access, and current staffing capability with no transition time needed to continue operation until the competitive award can be made again. If the operation experiences a lapse in service, there will be unacceptable delays in the pilot training program causing pilot training quotas to be missed. This would leave the customer with an insufficient number of mission trained pilots, which would have a significant impact on operations with national security implications.

8) Statement of the Actions, if Any, the Agency May Take to Remove or Overcome any Barriers that Led to the Restricted Consideration Before Any Subsequent Acquisition for the Supplies or Services is Made:

Based on the acquisition team's experience with previously awarded task orders for aircraft maintenance in support of the USMC, there has been competition for multiple solicitations to include the most recent one. Barriers to future competition are not anticipated. A competitive award is anticipated to be released by January 2, 2026, this will allow enough time for the GSA INFORM process and a 30 transition period if needed. A nine (9) month bridge all for additional market research to identify more than the two sources received last time as well as giving bidders additional time that was requested during recent market research.

9) Task ordering Officer Certification that the Justification is Accurate and Complete to the Best of the Task ordering Officer's Knowledge and Belief:

I certify that this justification is accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief, and I determine on the basis of the findings above that a sole source approach for this bridge task order is in accordance with the requirements and is in the best interest of the Government.

DocuSigned by:

Kevin Albertson

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Kevin Albertson

Contracting Officer

AAS Air Force/Navy/Space Force

Assisted Acquisition Services (AAS)

Date 3/27/2025

10) Evidence that any Supporting Data that is the Responsibility of Technical or Requirements Personnel and Which Form a Basis for the Justification Have Been Certified as Complete and Accurate by the Technical and Requirements Personnel (If Any):

Supporting data provided by technical or requirements personnel has been certified as complete and accurate as demonstrated by signature below.

[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
VMMT-204 Raptors
Technical Point of Contact
Date 3/27/2025

11) Written Determination by Approving Official Identifying the Circumstance that Applies:

I hereby certify that this justification is accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge, and I determine on the basis of the findings above that the sole source approach for this bridge contract is in accordance with the requirements and is in the best interest of the Government.

[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
Advocate for Competition, AAS Air Force/Navy/Space Force
Assisted Acquisition Services (AAS)
Date 3/27/2025

12) Reviews/Approvals

I have reviewed this justification, and I have determined to the best of my knowledge and belief, based on the information contained herein, that it complies with all applicable policies and regulations.

[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
Contracting Executive, AAS Air Force/Navy/Space Force
Assisted Acquisition Services (AAS)
Date 3/27/2025